

Task Risk Assessment

With COSHH Compliance

sevron

Before Controls	HIGH 16 RISK	MEDIUM 6 RISK	After Controls

Task Title	Using the Qiagen EpiTect Bisulfite kit - Copy		
Process Title	Methylation-specific PCR		
Location	Mallon Group		
Assessed On	22/01/2026	Assessed By	Christian Thomas,
Review Date	22/01/2029	Reference	GEN1220518
Signed By	Christian Thomas	Revision	1
People Affected	Lab Users		

Hazards



PPE



Task/Procedure/Method Statement

The protocol includes the use of various buffers provided with the EpiTect kit. Depending on requirements, the maximum volume of the Bisulfite mix added will be 100 ul.

Storage considerations:

The columns provided in the kit should be kept in the fridge at 2 - 8 degrees. The rest of the kit, buffers, etc should be stored at room temperature.

Specific hazards:

The EpiTect kit buffers contain:

Guanidine thiocyanate (in Buffer BL) - corrosive to metals, acute toxicity, serious eye damage, long-term aquatic hazard

Sodium hydroxide (in Buffer BD) - corrosive to metals, skin corrosion, serious eye damage

Tetrahydrofurfuryl alcohol (in DNA Protect buffer) - eye irritation, reproductive toxicity

Sodium metabisulfite (in Bisulfite Mix) - acute toxicity, serious eye damage

Other health effects:

Harmful in contact with the skin or if inhaled or swallowed. May damage the unborn child. Suspected of damaging fertility.

PPE required:

Use nitrile gloves and a lab coat.

Accidental spillage:

Wipe up solution with a dry tissue and dispose of via the autoclave waste route.

Disposal:

Dispose of excess/used product via the autoclave waste route. Do not pour down the drains (Buffer BL poses a long-term threat to aquatic life).

Substance Information

Product Name

Guanidine thiocyanate (G6639)

Manufacturer

Merck Life Science UK Limited

Hazard Symbols



Regulatory Statements

H302: Harmful if swallowed

H312: Harmful in contact with skin

H314: Causes severe skin burns and eye damage

H332: Harmful if inhaled

H412: Harmful to aquatic life with long lasting effects

P260): Do not breathe dust/fume/gas/mist/vapours/spray

P280): Wear protective gloves/protective clothing/eye protection/face protection

P303+P361+P353): IF ON SKIN (or hair)Remove/Take off immediately all contaminated clothing. Rinse skin with water/shower

P305+P351+P338): IF IN EYESRinse cautiously with water for several minutes. Remove contact lenses if present and easy to do – continue rinsing

Application Method	Application Area	Frequency Of Use	Quantity Used	Duration Use
Qiagen EpiTect kit	ADR219	Occasional	<100 ul	30 minutes

Spillage, Storage & Waste

Storage, spillage and disposal - see previous (assessment details)

Product Name

Sodium hydroxide (S5881)

Manufacturer

Merck Life Science UK Limited

Hazard Symbols



Regulatory Statements

H290: May be corrosive to metals

H314: Causes severe skin burns and eye damage

H318: Causes serious eye damage

+}): +: physician2

P234): Keep only in original container

P260): Do not breathe dust/fume/gas/mist/vapours/spray

P280): Wear protective gloves/protective clothing/eye protection/face protection

P303+P361+P353): IF ON SKIN (or hair)Remove/Take off immediately all contaminated clothing. Rinse skin with water/shower

P304+P340+P310): If inhaled:remove person to freshair and keep comfortable for breathing. Immediately call a POISON CENTER/doctor.

P305+P351+P338): IF IN EYESRinse cautiously with water for several minutes. Remove contact lenses if present and easy to do – continue rinsing

Application Method	Application Area	Frequency Of Use	Quantity Used	Duration Use
Qiagen EpiTect kit	ADR219	Occasional	<100 ul	30 minutes

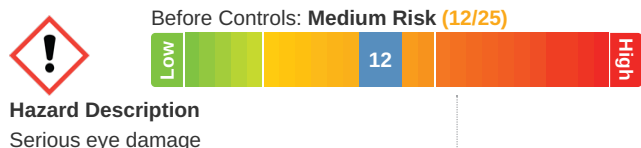
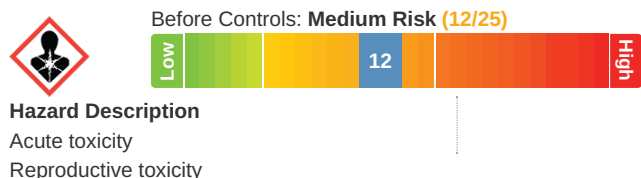
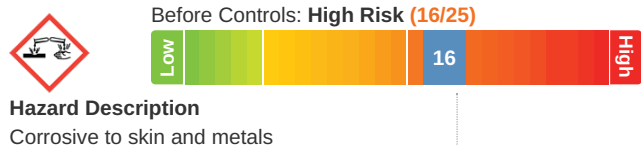
Spillage, Storage & Waste

Storage, spillage and disposal - see previous assessment details

Product Name TETRAHYDROFURFURYL ALCOHOL (93RMS07900)	Manufacturer Frutarom (UK) Ltd	Hazard Symbols 										
Regulatory Statements H319: Causes serious eye irritation P260: Do not breathe dust/fume/gas/mist/vapours/spray P301+P310: IF SWALLOWED Immediately call a POISON CENTER or doctor/physician P304+P312: If inhaled: call a poison center or doctor/physician if you feel unwell P403+P235: Store in a well ventilated place. Keep cool H360: May damage fertility or the unborn child P262: Do not get in eyes, on skin, or on clothing P303+P361+P353: IF ON SKIN (or hair) Remove/Take off immediately all contaminated clothing. Rinse skin with water/shower P304+P340: IF INHALED Remove victim to fresh air and keep at rest in a position comfortable for breathing												
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Qiagen EpiText kit	ADR219	Ocassional	<100 ul	30 minutes								
Spillage, Storage & Waste Storage, spillage and disposal - see previous assessment details												

Product Name Sodium metabisulfite (S9000)	Manufacturer Sigma-Aldrich	Hazard Symbols 										
Regulatory Statements H302: Harmful if swallowed P264: Wash ??please see SDS?? thoroughly after handling P280: Wear protective gloves/protective clothing/eye protection/face protection P501: Dispose of contents/container to ??please see SDS?? H318: Causes serious eye damage P270: Do not eat, drink or smoke when using this product P301 + P312: if swallowed: call a poison center/ doctor if you feel unwell P305 + P351 + P338: if in eyes: rinse cautiously with water												
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Task Related Hazards & Controls





Before Controls: **High Risk (16/25)**



After Controls: **Low Risk (3/25)**



Hazard Description

Long-term aquatic damage

General Controls & Emergency Controls

Controls In Place



Wear Labcoats



Wear protective gloves (nitrile)



Refer to instruction manual/booklet



No eating or drinking



Wash your hands

Emergency Controls In Place



Fire blanket



Fire extinguisher



First aid



Eyewash station

Linked Documents

Reference	Title	Uploaded By	Uploaded At
166094	Qiagen	Christian Thomas	2026-01-22 15:03:56